



Colorado State Committee Meeting – April 23, 2026

Regular Session Minutes

Meeting Time: 4:40 PM

Meeting Place: Virtual Meeting via Teams

Members Present: Don Brown, Chairperson
Darrell Mackey, Member
Kyle McConnell, Member
Steve Raftopoulos, Member
Joe Petrocco, Member

Staff Present: Jerry Sonnenberg, State Executive Director
Jon Weishaar, Deputy State Executive Director
Corey Pelton, Farm Program Chief
Janae Rader, Farm Program Specialist
Doug Andresen, Farm Program Specialist
Hunter Cleveland, Farm Program Specialist
Julie Sporhase, Farm Program Specialist
Woody Woods, District Director
Scott Brase, District Director
Sam Montoya, District Director

Guests: None

1. Call to Order

The Colorado State Committee (STC) met on April 23, 2026, via TEAMS with Don Brown in person at the Colorado State office in Lakewood. Don Brown, State Committee Chairperson, opened the Regular Session at 4:40 p.m.

2. Approval of Regular Session Minutes

The STC reviewed the Regular Session minutes from the meetings on January 6, 2026; February 10, 2026; and March 24, 2026. After due consideration and discussion, Kyle McConnell moved to approve and accept the minutes. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. The motion passed.

3. Leadership Reports (Exhibit 1)

A. State Executive Director Report

Jerry Sonnenberg, State Executive Director, submitted his written report and asked if there were any comments or questions.

B. District Director Reports

District Directors, Scott Brase (District 1), Jon Weishaar (Acting for District 2), Woody Woods (District 3) and Sam Montoya (District 4) gave the STC written reports regarding their specific districts and included information pertaining to programs, staffing updates, weather conditions, and other pertinent information since the last STC meeting.

C. Acting Farm Loan Chief Report

Kim Lacy, Acting Farm Loan Program Chief, provided the STC with a written report of items, events, and pertinent information regarding farm loan and staff since the last STC meeting.

D. Farm Program Chief Reports

Cindy Vukasin, Farm Program Chief, gave the STC a written report of items, events, and pertinent information regarding farm programs and staff since the last STC meeting.

Corey Pelton, Farm Program Chief, gave the STC a written report of items, events, and pertinent information regarding farm programs and staff since the last STC meeting and was available for questions and comments.

E. Deputy State Executive Director Report

Jon Weishaar, Deputy State Executive Director, gave the STC a written report of items, events, and pertinent information since the last STC meeting. He also provided numerous updates since the written report was filed and was available of questions and comments.

4. County Committee SDA Advisor Appointments

Jon Weishaar, DSED, presented the STC with the information in Exhibit 2 regarding the 2026 Colorado COC Socially Disadvantaged (SDA) Advisor Recommendations for Boulder and Morgan Counties. After due consideration and discussion, Joe Petrocco moved to appoint the 2026 Colorado COC SDA Advisor Recommendation for Boulder County and Morgan County as presented. Kyle McConnell seconded the motion. The motion passed.

5. County Committee Local Administrative Area (LAA) Review

Jon Weishaar, DSED, presented the STC with the information in Exhibit 3 regarding the 2026 Colorado Local Administrative Area (LAA) Boundary Certifications. After due consideration and discussion, Kyle McConnell moved to approve all of the 2026 Colorado LAA boundary certifications as submitted. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. The motion passed.

6. Noninsured Crop Disaster Assistance Program (NAP)

A. 2025 Independent Assessment Grazing Losses

Janae Rader, FPS, presented the STC with the information in Exhibit 4 regarding the 2025 grazing loss percentages for multiple counties.

After due consideration and discussion, Steve Raftopoulos moved to concur with the COC recommended present loss for 2025 non-irrigated grass and improved grass for producers using Independent Assessments as presented. Joe Petrocco seconded the motion. The motion passed.

After due consideration and discussion, Steve Raftopoulos moved to concur with the COC recommended present loss for 2025 irrigated grass and improved grass for producers using Independent Assessments as presented. Darrell Mackey seconded the motion. The motion passed.

B. Grazing Period & Carrying Capacity Discussion

The STC discussed an option of allowing County Committees (COCs) to determine grazing periods for their areas. Both Utah and Wyoming allow COCs to set the grazing period for their areas and the STC would like more information on how those other states accomplish these policies. The STC discussed how changing grazing periods could affect program benefits and other factors such as the carrying capacity. The STC also considered the timeline in which a change would need to be requested. The STO will provide more information at the next STC meeting.

7. State Committee Field Discussion update

There was a brief discussion regarding the Republican River Water Conservation District and the potential impacts of terminating a CREP contract. Concern was raised that if contracts were cancelled, this could impact the compact agreement with Nebraska and Kansas on the Republican River.

8. Adjourn Regular Session

Having no other business to discuss, Darrell Mackey moved to adjourn the Regular Session meeting. Joe Petrocco seconded the motion. The motion passed.

The Regular Session meeting was adjourned at 5:38 p.m.

Next STC Regular meeting set for May 28, 2026.

Approved:

State Committee Chairperson

Date

State Executive Director

Date

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